External support was fluid. Lashkar was considered the primary training provider and financier. It was also the most active in terms of transiting operatives between India and Pakistan via third countries such as Bangladesh, Nepal or those in the Gulf, often supplying false documents for these trips.[104] ISI agents are suspected of abetting these efforts, as well as with providing explosives training.[105] The Bangladeshi branch of Harkat-ul-Jihad-al-Islami [HuJI-B] is known to have furnished local actors with explosive material as well as facilitating the transit of weapons and other material across the Bangladesh border.[106] Sometimes Lashkar and HuJI-B worked in tandem, other times they worked independently. As Lashkar expanded its presence in Bangladesh over the course of the decade, the development of surrogate bases there and in Nepal enabled it to act more independently in terms of moving men, money and material into and out of India.

According to information provided by captured Lashkar operative David Headley, a Pakistani-American who performed reconnaissance on all of the targets hit during the 2008 Mumbai attacks, Karachi became a base in Pakistan for supporting Indian jihadism.[107] The sprawling port city is a natural entry and exit point for Indians traveling to and from Pakistan. In particular, it has traditional commercial links with Maharashtra (of which Mumbai is the capital) and Gujarat (where the 2002 pogroms occurred). It is also home to various organized criminal networks, including Dawood Ibrahim's D-Company. When the US Department of Treasury designated Ibrahim as a Specially Designated Global Terrorist in October 2003 it specifically noted his financial support for Lashkar-directed attacks in Gujarat.[108] His syndicate, along with other criminal networks, also would have continued to provide another means for smuggling guns, explosives and recruits into and out of India. Amir Khan is also believed to have fled to Karachi via Bangladesh in roughly 2003, and continued to contribute to coordinating attacks in India from there.[109] Notably, Lashkar worked with other criminal syndicates located elsewhere in Pakistan as well to move arms and explosives into India.[110]

Headley told investigators that at least two separate Lashkar units existed in Karachi for the purpose of launching or supporting attacks against India. Abdur Rehman Syed, the major who took early retirement and joined Lashkar in 2003, controlled one of them. Sajid Mir [a.k.a. Sajid